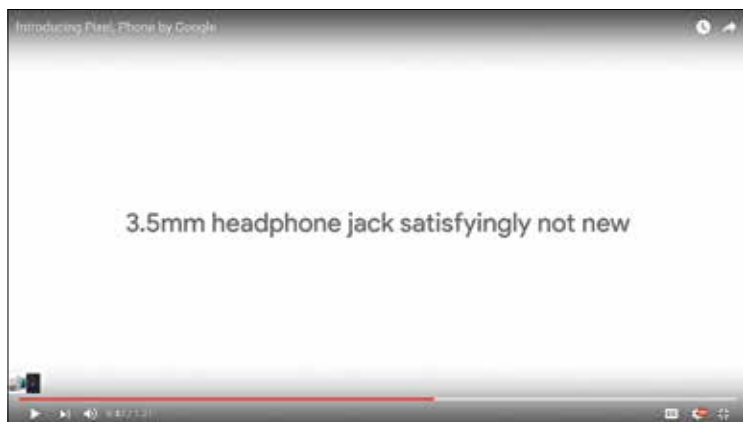


opinion, looks like a quick change-it-so-it-doesn't-look-the-same version of the LG V30 (LG is the contract manufacturer for the Pixel 2 XL in case you were wondering... it even looks like both the phones use the same screen panel). Hardware innovation just doesn't seem to be Google's cup of tea, at least in the realm of smartphone design. We reiterate, the Pixel phones right now still look like more evolved Nexuses than a phone designed by Google from the ground up. Having an FHD screen on a flagship in 2016 was a bit painful but having it even in 2017 is just downright bad. While it may improve the battery life, more and more people are using their phones



Pixel 2 isn't New anymore?

as their primary media consumption tool and thus, a bezel less, high resolution screen is something that a lot of people will appreciate. And the next HUGE sore point is the removal of the headphone jack. While it is fine that Google is trying to push its Pixel buds on us (instant translation IS pretty cool), cutting out a port that most people still find massively useful is a pretty major detractor. Especially when Google made fun of Apple the previous year for doing the same. And it's not like it's a widespread phenomenon either – most of the other flagships like the S8/S8+ still have it, and the LG G6/V30 take it a notch further with excellent quad DACs built in. The bitter truth is, while Google is amazing at making software decisions, it seems to be fumbling a bit with smartphones. The jury is still out on whether all the other connection and software issues from last year are solved this year, and we sincerely do hope that nothing major crops up – for Google's sake.